Experiment 9

Exploring AI-Assisted Features and Built-in Analytics (Zia) in Zoho Creator

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Title

Exploring AI-Assisted Features and Built-in Analytics (Zia) in Zoho Creator – Job Application Form (JAF) Application.

Aim

To explore the built-in analytics, interactive dashboard charts and report display options of the Job Application Form application in Zoho Creator, and to check the availability of AI-assisted (Zia) features in the application and its editor.

Objective

- To observe the charts, summary sections and report access buttons displayed on the application dashboard.
- To study the column chart and the pie chart of the dashboard and read the values they present.
- To identify the built-in display formats available for a report.
- To check the Design and Workflow areas of the application editor for Zia / AI-assisted options.

Software / Tools Required

- Zoho Creator (web-based low-code application development platform)
- Job Application Form (JAF) application created in Zoho Creator
- Web browser with an active internet connection
- Zoho account with access to the application and its editor

Introduction / Theory

AI-Assisted Features in Zoho Creator

AI-assisted features in a low-code platform are intended to help users build applications and understand their data with less manual effort. At a conceptual level, such features may assist with tasks such as generating insights from stored data, answering questions about data, or suggesting elements of an application. The availability of these features depends on the Zoho Creator edition, the plan of the account and the interface version in use.

Zia

Zia is the artificial-intelligence assistant of the Zoho ecosystem. Conceptually, Zia provides AI-driven capabilities, such as data insights and assistance in working with application data, within Zoho products. Whether and where Zia options appear in Zoho Creator depends on the account and plan.

Built-in Analytics and Dashboards

Zoho Creator provides built-in analytics through pages and dashboards, which present application data visually without external tools. A dashboard combines several components on one page so that the status of the application can be understood at a glance. The following components are commonly used:

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Component	Purpose
Charts	Represent data graphically, for example pie charts for proportional distribution and column charts for comparison between categories.
Summary / list sections	Present a grouped count of records, such as the number of records under each department.
Reports	Present records of a form in a structured manner, with columns for the fields of the form.
Interactive visualizations	Respond to user actions such as hovering, which displays the exact value represented by a chart segment or bar.

Report Display Formats

A report in Zoho Creator can be shown in more than one display format through the Show As option. Different formats present the same records in different ways, for instance as a list, on a calendar, along a timeline, in a spreadsheet layout or as a Kanban board, so that users can choose the format that suits the task.

Procedure

1. Open Zoho Creator and sign in. The home page lists the available applications.
2. Open the Job Application Form application and select Access this application to open it in its live (application) view.
3. Observe the left navigation menu, which lists Job Applications, Approvals and dashboard. Select dashboard and observe the Update button, the two charts, the Course Completion by Department section and the All Job Applications button.



Figure 9.1: Job Application Form Dashboard with Built-in Analytics

4. Examine the column chart, which plots Years_of_experience against the job type. Its legend shows Years_of_experience, and the Part-Time bar reaches the value 10 on the vertical axis.
5. Read the value of the bar from the chart. The pointer can be placed over the bar to view its value; the Part-Time category corresponds to Years_of_experience : 10.



Figure 9.2: Column Chart Showing Years of Experience by Job Type

6. Examine the pie chart, which shows the distribution of job applications by date. Its legend lists the date 08-Sep-2026 and the single segment carries the data label 1.
7. Read the value of the segment. The pointer can be placed over the segment to view its value; the date 08-Sep-2026 corresponds to the count 1.



Figure 9.3: Pie Chart Showing Job Applications by Date

8. Examine the Course Completion by Department section, which lists the department Software Development with the count 1.
9. Select the All Job Applications button below this section to open the job application report, and open the options menu (three dots) at the top-right corner of the report.
10. Open the Show As menu and record the options available: List, Calendar, Timeline, Spreadsheet, Kanban and Import. The menu is only viewed; no report view is changed or saved.



Figure 9.4: Dashboard Sections and Access to the All Job Applications Report

11. Select Edit this application to open the application editor, and check the Design area for any Zia, Analytics or AI-specific option.
12. Check the Workflow section of the editor. Workflow and form-related options are available, but no Zia / AI analytics feature is present.
13. Record that Zia / AI-assisted functionality was not available in the current account / interface.

Dashboard Analytics

The components of the Job Application Form dashboard displayed the following values:

Component	Observed Value
Column chart (Years_of_experience by job type)	Part-Time : 10
Pie chart (job applications by date)	08-Sep-2026 : 1
Course Completion by Department	Software Development : 1
Left navigation menu	Job Applications, Approvals, dashboard
Action buttons	Update, All Job Applications

The dashboard presents the stored job application data directly as charts and summary sections. The All Job Applications button gives access to the full report of the Job Application form, where the individual records are listed in columns for the fields of the form.

Interactive Chart Analysis

The charts on the dashboard present exact values for their bars and segments.

Chart	Value Read	Interpretation
Column chart (Years_of_experience by job type)	Part-Time : 10	The Part-Time category has a Years_of_experience value of 10.
Pie chart (job applications by date)	08-Sep-2026 : 1	One job application is recorded for the date 08-Sep-2026.

This shows that the dashboard charts provide interactive data details: the exact value behind a segment or bar can be read directly from the chart instead of being estimated visually.

Built-in Report Views

The Show As menu of the All Job Applications report lists the options below. The menu was only opened to explore the options; none of the views was applied, modified or saved.

Option	General Description	Use for Job Applications
List	Shows records as rows in a tabular list with a column for each field.	Default tabular view of all applications.
Calendar	Places records on a calendar according to a date field.	Applications placed by their application date.
Timeline	Arranges records chronologically along a timeline.	Sequence of applications over time.
Spreadsheet	Presents records in a grid layout similar to a spreadsheet.	Quick review and comparison of applicant data.

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Option	General Description	Use for Job Applications
Kanban	Displays records as cards grouped in columns, typically by status.	Applications grouped by approval status.
Import	Provides the option to bring data into the report's form from an external file.	Bulk entry of applicant records.

Zia / AI-Assisted Feature Exploration

The application and its editor were checked for Zia / AI-assisted functionality:

- Dashboard: the dashboard shows built-in charts and summary sections only; no Zia or AI-specific option was visible.
- Design area: inspected through the application editor. No Zia, Analytics or AI-specific option was visible.
- Workflow section: inspected. It contained workflow and form-related options, but no Zia / AI analytics feature was available.

Therefore, Zia / AI-assisted functionality was not available in the current account / interface. Zia was not used, configured or demonstrated in this experiment, and no AI-generated insights were obtained. The analytics demonstrated in this experiment are the built-in dashboard and reporting features of the application.

Result

The following were successfully carried out in the Job Application Form application:

- The dashboard components were observed: the Update button, the Years_of_experience column chart, the application date pie chart, the Course Completion by Department section and the All Job Applications button.
- The column chart (Part-Time : 10) and the pie chart (08-Sep-2026 : 1) were explored and their values read.
- The built-in report display options (List, Calendar, Timeline, Spreadsheet, Kanban and Import) were identified in the Show As menu.
- The Design and Workflow areas were checked for Zia / AI-assisted features; however, no such option was available in the current account / interface. Hence, Zia was not used in this experiment.

Conclusion

The experiment demonstrated the built-in analytics of Zoho Creator through the Job Application Form application. Charts summarise key figures such as Years_of_experience and application dates, summary sections group records by department, and the Show As menu offers several formats for viewing report data. These features help in monitoring job applications without external analytical tools. The Zia / AI-assisted functionality could not be explored because it was not available in the current account / interface. The practical work therefore covered the built-in dashboard analytics, chart values and report-view options.

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